01 Gen · Genesis

1 In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth. [2] Now the earth
was formless and void, and darkness was over the surface of the deep. And the
Spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters. [3] And God said, "Let
there be light," and there was light. [4] And God saw that the light was good, and
He separated the light from the darkness. [5] God called the light "day," and the
darkness He called "night." And there was evening, and there was morning—
the first day.

[6] And God said, "Let there be an expanse between the waters, to separate the
waters from the waters." [7] So God made the expanse and separated the waters
beneath it from the waters above. And it was so. [8] God called the expanse "sky."
And there was evening, and there was morning—the second day.

[9] And God said, "Let the waters under the sky be gathered into one place, so
that the dry land may appear." And it was so.

[10] God called the dry land "earth," and the gathering of waters He called
"seas." And God saw that it was good. [11] Then God said, "Let the earth bring
forth vegetation: seed-bearing plants and fruit trees, each bearing fruit with seed
according to its kind." And it was so. [12] The earth produced vegetation: seed-
bearing plants according to their kinds and trees bearing fruit with seed according
to their kinds. And God saw that it was good. [13] And there was evening, and there
was morning—the third day.

[14] And God said, "Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to distinguish
between the day and the night, and let them be signs to mark the seasons and
days and years." [15] "And let them serve as lights in the expanse of the sky to shine
upon the earth." And it was so. [16] God made two great lights: the greater light to
rule the day and the lesser light to rule the night. And He made the stars as well.
[17] God set these lights in the expanse of the sky to shine upon the earth, [18] to
preside over the day and the night, and to separate the light from the darkness.
And God saw that it was good. [19] And there was evening, and there was morning
—the fourth day.

[20] And God said, "Let the waters teem with living creatures, and let birds fly
above the earth in the open expanse of the sky." [21] So God created the great
sea creatures and every living thing that moves, with which the waters teemed
according to their kinds, and every bird of flight after its kind. And God saw that
it was good. [22] Then God blessed them and said, "Be fruitful and multiply and
fill the waters of the seas, and let birds multiply on the earth." [23] And there was
evening, and there was morning—the fifth day.

[24] And God said, "Let the earth bring forth living creatures according to their
kinds: livestock, land crawlers, and beasts of the earth according to their kinds."
And it was so. [25] God made the beasts of the earth according to their kinds, the
livestock according to their kinds, and everything that crawls upon the earth
according to its kind. And God saw that it was good. [26] Then God said, "Let Us
make man in Our image, after Our likeness, to rule over the fish of the sea and the
birds of the air, over the livestock, and over all the earth itself and every creature
that crawls upon it." [27] So God created man in His own image; in the image of
God He created him; male and female He created them. [28] God blessed them and
said to them, "Be fruitful and multiply, and fill the earth and subdue it; rule over
the fish of the sea and the birds of the air and every creature that crawls upon
the earth." [29] Then God said, "Behold, I have given you every seed-bearing plant
on the face of all the earth, and every tree whose fruit contains seed. They will be
yours for food." [30] "And to every beast of the earth and every bird of the air and
every creature that crawls upon the earth—everything that has the breath of life
in it—I have given every green plant for food." And it was so. [31] And God looked
upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good. And there was evening,
and there was morning—the sixth day.

2 Thus the heavens and the earth were completed in all their vast array. [2] And
by the seventh day God had finished the work He had been doing; so on that
day He rested from all His work. [3] Then God blessed the seventh day and
sanctified it, because on that day He rested from all the work of creation that
He had accomplished.

[4] This is the account of the heavens and the earth when they were created, in
the day that the LORD God made them. [5] Now no shrub of the field had yet
appeared on the earth, nor had any plant of the field sprouted; for the LORD
God had not yet sent rain upon the earth, and there was no man to cultivate
the ground. [6] But springs welled up from the earth and watered the whole
surface of the ground. [7] Then the LORD God formed man from the dust of
the ground and breathed the breath of life into his nostrils, and the man became
a living being.

[8] And the LORD God planted a garden in Eden, in the east, where He placed
the man He had formed. [9] Out of the ground the LORD God gave growth to
every tree that is pleasing to the eye and good for food. And in the middle of
the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.
[10] Now a river flowed out of Eden to water the garden, and from there it branched
into four headwaters: [11] The name of the first river is Pishon; it winds through
the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold. [12] And the gold of that land is
pure, and bdellium and onyx are found there. [13] The name of the second river
is Gihon; it winds through the whole land of Cush. [14] The name of the third
river is Hiddekel; it runs along the east side of Assyria. And the fourth river is
the Euphrates. [15] Then the LORD God took the man and placed him in the
Garden of Eden to cultivate and keep it.

[16] And the LORD God commanded him, "You may eat freely from every tree
of the garden," [17] "but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good
and evil; for in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die."

[18] The LORD God also said, "It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make
for him a suitable helper." [19] And out of the ground the LORD God formed
every beast of the field and every bird of the air, and He brought them to the man
to see what he would name each one. And whatever the man called each living
creature, that was its name. [20] The man gave names to all the livestock, to the
birds of the air, and to every beast of the field. But for Adam no suitable helper
was found. [21] So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep, and
while he slept, He took one of the man's ribs and closed up the area with flesh.
[22] And from the rib that the LORD God had taken from the man, He made
a woman and brought her to him. [23] And the man said: "This is now bone of
my bones and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called 'woman,' for out of man she
was taken." [24] For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united
to his wife, and they will become one flesh. [25] And the man and his wife were
both naked, and they were not ashamed.

3 Now the serpent was more crafty than any beast of the field that the LORD
God had made. And he said to the woman, "Did God really say, 'You must not
eat from any tree in the garden?'" [2] The woman answered the serpent, "We may
eat the fruit of the trees of the garden," [3] "but about the fruit of the tree in the
middle of the garden, God has said, 'You must not eat of it or touch it, or you
will die.'" [4] "You will not surely die," the serpent told her. [5] "For God knows
that in the day you eat of it, your eyes will be opened and you will be like God,
knowing good and evil." [6] When the woman saw that the tree was good for food
and pleasing to the eyes, and that it was desirable for obtaining wisdom, she took
the fruit and ate it. She also gave some to her husband who was with her, and he
ate it. [7] And the eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were
naked; so they sewed together fig leaves and made coverings for themselves.

[8] Then the man and his wife heard the voice of the LORD God walking in
the garden in the breeze of the day, and they hid themselves from the presence of
the LORD God among the trees of the garden. [9] But the LORD God called out
to the man, "Where are you?" [10] "I heard Your voice in the garden," he replied,
"and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid myself." [11] "Who told you that you
were naked?" asked the LORD God. "Have you eaten from the tree of which
I commanded you not to eat?" [12] And the man answered, "The woman whom
You gave me, she gave me fruit from the tree, and I ate it."

[13] Then the LORD God said to the woman, "What is this you have done?"
"The serpent deceived me," she replied, "and I ate." [14] So the LORD God said
to the serpent: "Because you have done this, cursed are you above all livestock
and every beast of the field! On your belly will you go, and dust you will eat, all
the days of your life." [15] "And I will put enmity between you and the woman,
and between your seed and her seed. He will crush your head, and you will strike
his heel."

[16] To the woman He said: "I will sharply increase your pain in childbirth; in pain
you will bring forth children. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will
rule over you." [17] And to Adam He said: "Because you have listened to the voice
of your wife and have eaten from the tree of which I commanded you not to
eat, cursed is the ground because of you; through toil you will eat of it all the
days of your life." [18] Both thorns and thistles it will yield for you, and you will
eat the plants of the field. [19] "By the sweat of your brow you will eat your bread,
until you return to the ground— because out of it were you taken. For dust you
are, and to dust you shall return." [20] And Adam named his wife Eve, because she
would be the mother of all the living. [21] And the LORD God made garments
of skin for Adam and his wife, and He clothed them. [22] Then the LORD God
said, "Behold, the man has become like one of Us, knowing good and evil. And
now, lest he reach out his hand and take also from the tree of life, and eat, and
live forever..." [23] Therefore the LORD God banished him from the Garden of
Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken. [24] So He drove out the
man and stationed cherubim on the east side of the Garden of Eden, along with
a whirling sword of flame to guard the way to the tree of life.

4 And Adam had relations with his wife Eve, and she conceived and gave birth
to Cain. "With the help of the LORD I have brought forth a man," she said.
[2] Later she gave birth to Cain's brother Abel. Now Abel was a keeper of sheep,
while Cain was a tiller of the soil. [3] So in the course of time, Cain brought some
of the fruit of the soil as an offering to the LORD, [4] while Abel brought the best
portions of the firstborn of his flock. And the LORD looked with favor on Abel
and his offering, [5] but He had no regard for Cain and his offering. So Cain became
very angry, and his countenance fell. [6] "Why are you angry," said the LORD to
Cain, "and why has your countenance fallen?" [7] "If you do what is right, will you
not be accepted? But if you refuse to do what is right, sin is crouching at your
door; it desires you, but you must master it."

[8] Then Cain said to his brother Abel, "Let us go out to the field." And while
they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel and killed him. [9] And
the LORD said to Cain, "Where is your brother Abel?" "I do not know!" he
answered. "Am I my brother's keeper?" [10] "What have you done?" replied the
LORD. "The voice of your brother's blood cries out to Me from the ground."
[11] Now you are cursed and banished from the ground, which has opened its
mouth to receive your brother's blood from your hand. [12] "When you till the
ground, it will no longer yield its produce to you. You will be a fugitive and a
wanderer on the earth."
[13] But Cain said to the LORD, "My punishment is greater than I can bear."
[14] "Behold, this day You have driven me from the face of the earth, and from Your
face I will be hidden; I will be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth, and whoever
finds me will kill me." [15] "Not so!" replied the LORD. "If anyone slays Cain, then
Cain will be avenged sevenfold." And the LORD placed a mark on Cain, so that
no one who found him would kill him. [16] So Cain went out from the presence
of the LORD and settled in the land of Nod, east of Eden.

[17] And Cain had relations with his wife, and she conceived and gave birth to
Enoch. Then Cain built a city and named it after his son Enoch. [18] Now to Enoch
was born Irad, and Irad was the father of Mehujael, and Mehujael was the father
of Methusael, and Methusael was the father of Lamech. [19] And Lamech married
two women, one named Adah and the other Zillah. [20] Adah gave birth to Jabal; he
was the father of those who dwell in tents and raise livestock. [21] And his brother's
name was Jubal; he was the father of all who play the harp and flute. [22] And Zillah
gave birth to Tubal-cain, a forger of every implement of bronze and iron. And the
sister of Tubal-cain was Naamah. [23] Then Lamech said to his wives: "Adah and
Zillah, hear my voice; wives of Lamech, listen to my speech. For I have slain a man
for wounding me, a young man for striking me." [24] "If Cain is avenged sevenfold,
then Lamech seventy-sevenfold." [25] And Adam again had relations with his wife,
and she gave birth to a son and named him Seth, saying, "God has granted me
another seed in place of Abel, since Cain killed him." [26] And to Seth also a son
was born, and he called him Enosh. At that time men began to call upon the
name of the LORD.

5 This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created
man, He made him in His own likeness. [2] Male and female He created them, and
He blessed them. And in the day they were created, He called them "man."
[3] When Adam was 130 years old, he had a son in his own likeness, after his own
image; and he named him Seth.
[4] And after he had become the father of Seth, Adam lived 800 years and had
other sons and daughters.
[5] So Adam lived a total of 930 years, and then he died.
[6] When Seth was 105 years old, he became the father of Enosh.
[7] And after he had become the father of Enosh, Seth lived 807 years and had
other sons and daughters.
[8] So Seth lived a total of 912 years, and then he died.
[9] When Enosh was 90 years old, he became the father of Kenan.
[10] And after he had become the father of Kenan, Enosh lived 815 years and had
other sons and daughters.
[11] So Enosh lived a total of 905 years, and then he died.
[12] When Kenan was 70 years old, he became the father of Mahalalel.
[13] And after he had become the father of Mahalalel, Kenan lived 840 years and
had other sons and daughters.
[14] So Kenan lived a total of 910 years, and then he died.
[15] When Mahalalel was 65 years old, he became the father of Jared.
[16] And after he had become the father of Jared, Mahalalel lived 830 years and
had other sons and daughters.
[17] So Mahalalel lived a total of 895 years, and then he died.
[18] When Jared was 162 years old, he became the father of Enoch.
[19] And after he had become the father of Enoch, Jared lived 800 years and had
other sons and daughters.
[20] So Jared lived a total of 962 years, and then he died.
[21] When Enoch was 65 years old, he became the father of Methuselah.
[22] And after he had become the father of Methuselah, Enoch walked with God
300 years and had other sons and daughters.
[23] So Enoch lived a total of 365 years.
[24] Enoch walked with God, and then he was no more, because God had taken
him away.
[25] When Methuselah was 187 years old, he became the father of Lamech.
[26] And after he had become the father of Lamech, Methuselah lived 782 years
and had other sons and daughters.
[27] So Methuselah lived a total of 969 years, and then he died.
[28] When Lamech was 182 years old, he had a son.
[29] And he named him Noah, saying, "May this one comfort us in the labor and
toil of our hands caused by the ground that the LORD has cursed."
[30] And after he had become the father of Noah, Lamech lived 595 years and
had other sons and daughters.
[31] So Lamech lived a total of 777 years, and then he died.
[32] After Noah was 500 years old, he became the father of Shem, Ham,
and Japheth.

6 Now when men began to multiply on the face of the earth and daughters
were born to them, [2] the sons of God saw that the daughters of men were
beautiful, and they took as wives whomever they chose. [3] So the LORD said,
"My Spirit will not contend with man forever, for he is mortal; his days shall
be 120 years." [4] The Nephilim were on the earth in those days—and afterward
as well—when the sons of God had relations with the daughters of men. And
they bore them children who became the mighty men of old, men of renown.
[5] Then the LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great upon the earth, and
that every inclination of the thoughts of his heart was altogether evil all the time.
[6] And the LORD regretted that He had made man on the earth, and He was
grieved in His heart.
[7] So the LORD said, "I will blot out man, whom I have created, from the face
of the earth—every man and beast and crawling creature and bird of the air—for
I am grieved that I have made them." [8] Noah, however, found favor in the eyes of
the LORD. [9] This is the account of Noah. Noah was a righteous man, blameless
in his generation; Noah walked with God. [10] And Noah had three sons: Shem,
Ham, and Japheth. [11] Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and full
of violence. [12] And God looked upon the earth and saw that it was corrupt; for
all living creatures on the earth had corrupted their ways.
[13] Then God said to Noah, "The end of all living creatures has come before Me,
because through them the earth is full of violence. Now behold, I will destroy
both them and the earth."

[14] Make for yourself an ark of gopher wood; make rooms in the ark and coat it
with pitch inside and out. [15] And this is how you are to build it: The ark is to be
300 cubits long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. [16] You are to make a roof for
the ark, finish its walls a cubit from the top, place a door in the side of the ark,
and build lower, middle, and upper decks. [17] And behold, I will bring floodwaters
upon the earth to destroy every creature under the heavens that has the breath
of life. Everything on the earth will perish. [18] But I will establish My covenant
with you, and you will enter the ark—you and your sons and your wife and your
sons' wives with you. [19] And you are to bring two of every living creature into
the ark—male and female—to keep them alive with you. [20] Two of every kind of
bird and animal and crawling creature will come to you to be kept alive. [21] "You
are also to take for yourself every kind of food that is eaten and gather it as food
for yourselves and for the animals." [22] So Noah did everything precisely as God
had commanded him.

7 Then the LORD said to Noah, "Go into the ark, you and all your family,
because I have found you righteous in this generation." [2] You are to take with you
seven pairs of every kind of clean animal, a male and its mate; a pair of every kind
of unclean animal, a male and its mate; [3] and seven pairs of every kind of bird of
the air, male and female, to preserve their offspring on the face of all the earth.
[4] "For seven days from now I will send rain on the earth for forty days and forty
nights, and I will wipe from the face of the earth every living thing I have made."
[5] And Noah did all that the LORD had commanded him. [6] Now Noah was 600
years old when the floodwaters came upon the earth. [7] And Noah and his wife,
with his sons and their wives, entered the ark to escape the waters of the flood.
[8] The clean and unclean animals, the birds, and everything that crawls along
the ground [9] came to Noah to enter the ark, two by two, male and female, as
God had commanded Noah. [10] And after seven days the floodwaters came upon
the earth.
[11] In the six hundredth year of Noah's life, on the seventeenth day of the second
month, all the fountains of the great deep burst forth, and the floodgates of
the heavens were opened. [12] And the rain fell upon the earth for forty days and
forty nights. [13] On that very day Noah entered the ark, along with his sons Shem,
Ham, and Japheth, and his wife, and the three wives of his sons— [14] they and
every kind of wild animal, livestock, crawling creature, bird, and winged creature.
[15] They came to Noah to enter the ark, two by two of every creature with the
breath of life.

[16] And they entered, the male and female of every living thing, as God had
commanded Noah. Then the LORD shut him in. [17] For forty days the flood kept
coming on the earth, and the waters rose and lifted the ark high above the earth.
[18] So the waters continued to surge and rise greatly on the earth, and the ark
floated on the surface of the waters. [19] Finally, the waters completely inundated
the earth, so that all the high mountains under all the heavens were covered.
[20] The waters rose and covered the mountaintops to a depth of fifteen cubits.
[21] And every living thing that moved upon the earth perished—birds, livestock,
animals, every creature that swarms upon the earth, and all mankind. [22] Of all that
was on dry land, everything that had the breath of life in its nostrils died. [23] And
every living thing on the face of the earth was destroyed—man and livestock,
crawling creatures and birds of the air; they were blotted out from the earth, and
only Noah and those with him in the ark remained. [24] And the waters prevailed
upon the earth for 150 days.

8 But God remembered Noah and all the animals and livestock that were
with him in the ark. And God sent a wind over the earth, and the waters
began to subside. [2] The springs of the deep and the floodgates of the heavens
were closed, and the rain from the sky was restrained. [3] The waters receded
steadily from the earth, and after 150 days the waters had gone down. [4] On the
seventeenth day of the seventh month, the ark came to rest on the mountains
of Ararat. [5] And the waters continued to recede until the tenth month, and on

the first day of the tenth month the tops of the mountains became visible. [6] After forty days Noah opened the window he had made in the ark
[7] and sent out a raven. It kept flying back and forth until the waters had dried up from the earth. [8] Then Noah sent out a dove to see if the waters had receded from the surface of the ground. [9] But the dove found no place to rest her foot, and she returned to him in the ark, because the waters were still covering the surface of all the earth. So he reached out his hand and brought her back inside the ark.

[10] Noah waited seven more days and again sent out the dove from the ark. [11] And behold, the dove returned to him in the evening with a freshly plucked olive leaf in her beak. So Noah knew that the waters had receded from the earth. [12] And Noah waited seven more days and sent out the dove again, but this time she did not return to him. [13] In Noah's six hundred and first year, on the first day of the first month, the waters had dried up from the earth. So Noah removed the covering from the ark and saw that the surface of the ground was dry.

[14] By the twenty-seventh day of the second month, the earth was fully dry. [15] Then God said to Noah, [16] "Come out of the ark, you and your wife, along with your sons and their wives." [17] "Bring out all the living creatures that are with you—birds, livestock, and everything that crawls upon the ground—so that they can spread out over the earth and be fruitful and multiply upon it." [18] So Noah came out, along with his sons and his wife and his sons' wives. [19] Every living creature, every creeping thing, and every bird—everything that moves upon the earth—came out of the ark, kind by kind. [20] Then Noah built an altar to the LORD. And taking from every kind of clean animal and clean bird, he offered burnt offerings on the altar. [21] When the LORD smelled the pleasing aroma, He said in His heart, "Never again will I curse the ground because of man, even though every inclination of his heart is evil from his youth. And never again will I destroy all living creatures as I have done." [22] "As long as the earth endures, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night shall never cease."

9 And God blessed Noah and his sons and said to them, "Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth." [2] The fear and dread of you will fall on every living creature on the earth, every bird of the air, every creature that crawls on the ground, and all the fish of the sea. They are delivered into your hand. [3] Everything that lives and moves will be food for you; just as I gave you the green plants, I now give you all things. [4] But you must not eat meat with its lifeblood still in it. [5] And surely I will require the life of any man or beast by whose hand your lifeblood is shed. I will demand an accounting from anyone who takes the life of his fellow man: [6] Whoever sheds the blood of man, by man his blood will be shed; for in His own image God has made mankind. [7] "But as for you, be fruitful and multiply; spread out across the earth and multiply upon it." [8] Then God said to Noah and his sons with him, [9] "Behold, I now establish My covenant with you and your descendants after you," [10] and with every living creature that was with you—the birds, the livestock, and every beast of the earth—every living thing that came out of the ark. [11] "And I establish My covenant with you: Never again will all life be cut off by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth."

[12] And God said, "This is the sign of the covenant I am making between Me and you and every living creature with you, a covenant for all generations to come:" [13] I have set My rainbow in the clouds, and it will be a sign of the covenant between Me and the earth. [14] Whenever I form clouds over the earth and the rainbow appears in the clouds, [15] I will remember My covenant between Me and you and every living creature of every kind. Never again will the waters become a flood to destroy all life. [16] "And whenever the rainbow appears in the clouds, I will see it and remember the everlasting covenant between God and every living creature of every kind that is on the earth." [17] So God said to Noah, "This is the sign of the covenant that I have established between Me and every creature on the earth." [18] The sons of Noah who came out of the ark were Shem, Ham, and Japheth. And Ham was the father of Canaan.

[19] These three were the sons of Noah, and from them the whole earth was populated. [20] Now Noah, a man of the soil, proceeded to plant a vineyard. [21] But when he drank some of its wine, he became drunk and uncovered himself inside his tent. [22] And Ham, the father of Canaan, saw his father's nakedness and told his two brothers outside. [23] Then Shem and Japheth took a garment and placed it across their shoulders, and walking backward, they covered their father's nakedness. Their faces were turned away so that they did not see their father's nakedness. [24] When Noah awoke from his drunkenness and learned what his youngest son had done to him, [25] he said, "Cursed be Canaan! A servant of servants shall he be to his brothers." [26] He also declared: "Blessed be the LORD, the God of Shem! May Canaan be the servant of Shem." [27] "May God expand the territory of Japheth; may he dwell in the tents of Shem, and may Canaan be his servant." [28] After the flood, Noah lived 350 years. [29] So Noah lived a total of 950 years, and then he died.

10 This is the account of Noah's sons Shem, Ham, and Japheth, who also had sons after the flood.
[2] The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras.
[3] The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Riphath, and Togarmah.
[4] And the sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, the Kittites, and the Rodanites.
[5] From these, the maritime peoples separated into their territories, according to their languages, by clans within their nations.
[6] The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan.
[7] The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabtah, Raamah, and Sabteca. And the sons of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan.
[8] Cush was the father of Nimrod, who began to be a mighty one on the earth.
[9] He was a mighty hunter before the LORD; so it is said, "Like Nimrod, a mighty hunter before the LORD."
[10] His kingdom began in Babylon, Erech, Accad, and Calneh, in the land of Shinar.
[11] From that land he went forth into Assyria, where he built Nineveh, Rehoboth-Ir, Calah,
[12] and Resen, which is between Nineveh and the great city of Calah.
[13] Mizraim was the father of the Ludites, the Anamites, the Lehabites, the Naphtuhites,
[14] the Pathrusites, the Casluhites (from whom the Philistines came), and the Caphtorites.
[15] And Canaan was the father of Sidon his firstborn, and of the Hittites,
[16] the Jebusites, the Amorites, the Girgashites,
[17] the Hivites, the Arkites, the Sinites,
[18] the Arvadites, the Zemarites, and the Hamathites. Later the Canaanite clans were scattered,
[19] and the borders of Canaan extended from Sidon toward Gerar as far as Gaza, and then toward Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboiim, as far as Lasha.
[20] These are the sons of Ham according to their clans, languages, lands, and nations.
[21] And sons were also born to Shem, the older brother of Japheth; Shem was the forefather of all the sons of Eber.
[22] The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arphaxad, Lud, and Aram.
[23] The sons of Aram: Uz, Hul, Gether, and Mash.
[24] Arphaxad was the father of Shelah, and Shelah was the father of Eber.
[25] Two sons were born to Eber: One was named Peleg, because in his days the earth was divided, and his brother was named Joktan.
[26] And Joktan was the father of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah,
[27] Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah,
[28] Obal, Abimael, Sheba,
[29] Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these were sons of Joktan.
[30] Their territory extended from Mesha to Sephar, in the eastern hill country.
[31] These are the sons of Shem, according to their clans, languages, lands, and nations.
[32] All these are the clans of Noah's sons, according to their generations and nations. From these the nations of the earth spread out after the flood.

11 Now the whole world had one language and a common form of speech.
[2] And as people journeyed eastward, they found a plain in the land of Shinar and settled there. [3] And they said to one another, "Come, let us make bricks and bake them thoroughly." So they used brick instead of stone, and tar instead of mortar.
[4] "Come," they said, "let us build for ourselves a city with a tower that reaches to the heavens, that we may make a name for ourselves and not be scattered over the face of all the earth." [5] Then the LORD came down to see the city and the tower that the sons of men were building. [6] And the LORD said, "If they have begun to do this as one people speaking the same language, then nothing they devise will be beyond them." [7] "Come, let Us go down and confuse their language, so that they will not understand one another's speech." [8] So the LORD scattered them from there over the face of all the earth, and they stopped building the city.
[9] That is why it is called Babel, for there the LORD confused the language of the whole world, and from that place the LORD scattered them over the face of all the earth.
[10] This is the account of Shem. Two years after the flood, when Shem was 100 years old, he became the father of Arphaxad.
[11] And after he had become the father of Arphaxad, Shem lived 500 years and had other sons and daughters.
[12] When Arphaxad was 35 years old, he became the father of Shelah.
[13] And after he had become the father of Shelah, Arphaxad lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters.
[14] When Shelah was 30 years old, he became the father of Eber.
[15] And after he had become the father of Eber, Shelah lived 403 years and had other sons and daughters.
[16] When Eber was 34 years old, he became the father of Peleg.
[17] And after he had become the father of Peleg, Eber lived 430 years and had other sons and daughters.
[18] When Peleg was 30 years old, he became the father of Reu.
[19] And after he had become the father of Reu, Peleg lived 209 years and had other sons and daughters.
[20] When Reu was 32 years old, he became the father of Serug.
[21] And after he had become the father of Serug, Reu lived 207 years and had other sons and daughters.
[22] When Serug was 30 years old, he became the father of Nahor.
[23] And after he had become the father of Nahor, Serug lived 200 years and had other sons and daughters.
[24] When Nahor was 29 years old, he became the father of Terah.

[25] And after he had become the father of Terah, Nahor lived 119 years and had other sons and daughters.

[26] When Terah was 70 years old, he became the father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran. [27] This is the account of Terah. Terah became the father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran. And Haran became the father of Lot. [28] During his father Terah's lifetime, Haran died in his native land, in Ur of the Chaldeans. [29] And Abram and Nahor took wives for themselves. Abram's wife was named Sarai, and Nahor's wife was named Milcah; she was the daughter of Haran, who was the father of both Milcah and Iscah. [30] But Sarai was barren; she had no children. [31] And Terah took his son Abram, his grandson Lot son of Haran, and his daughter-in-law Sarai the wife of Abram, and they set out from Ur of the Chaldeans for the land of Canaan. But when they arrived in Haran, they settled there. [32] Terah lived 205 years, and he died in Haran.

12 Then the LORD said to Abram, "Leave your country, your kindred, and your father's household, and go to the land I will show you." [2] I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, so that you will be a blessing. [3] "I will bless those who bless you and curse those who curse you; and all the families of the earth will be blessed through you." [4] So Abram departed, as the LORD had directed him, and Lot went with him. Abram was seventy-five years old when he left Haran. [5] And Abram took his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, and all the possessions and people they had acquired in Haran, and set out for the land of Canaan. When they came to the land of Canaan, [6] Abram traveled through the land as far as the site of the Oak of Moreh at Shechem. And at that time the Canaanites were in the land. [7] Then the LORD appeared to Abram and said, "I will give this land to your offspring." So Abram built an altar there to the LORD, who had appeared to him. [8] From there Abram moved on to the hill country east of Bethel and pitched his tent, with Bethel to the west and Ai to the east. There he built an altar to the LORD, and he called on the name of the LORD. [9] And Abram journeyed on toward the Negev.

[10] Now there was a famine in the land. So Abram went down to Egypt to live there for a while because the famine was severe. [11] As he was about to enter Egypt, he said to his wife Sarai, "Look, I know that you are a beautiful woman," [12] and when the Egyptians see you, they will say, 'This is his wife.' Then they will kill me but will let you live. [13] "Please say you are my sister, so that I will be treated well for your sake, and on account of you my life will be spared." [14] So when Abram entered Egypt, the Egyptians saw that the woman was very beautiful. [15] When Pharaoh's officials saw Sarai, they commended her to him, and she was taken into the palace of Pharaoh. [16] He treated Abram well on her account, and Abram acquired sheep and cattle, male and female donkeys, menservants and maidservants, and camels. [17] The LORD, however, afflicted Pharaoh and his household with severe plagues because of Abram's wife Sarai. [18] So Pharaoh summoned Abram and asked, "What have you done to me? Why didn't you tell me she was your wife?" [19] "Why did you say, 'She is my sister,' so that I took her as my wife? Now then, here is your wife. Take her and go!" [20] Then Pharaoh gave his men orders concerning Abram, and they sent him away with his wife and all his possessions.

13 So Abram went up out of Egypt into the Negev—he and his wife and all his possessions—and Lot was with him. [2] And Abram had become extremely wealthy in livestock and silver and gold. [3] From the Negev he journeyed from place to place toward Bethel, until he came to the place between Bethel and Ai where his tent had formerly been pitched, [4] to the site where he had built the altar. And there Abram called on the name of the LORD. [5] Now Lot, who was traveling with Abram, also had flocks and herds and tents. [6] But the land was unable to support both of them while they stayed together, for they had so many possessions that they were unable to coexist. [7] And there was discord between the herdsmen of Abram and the herdsmen of Lot. At that time the Canaanites and the Perizzites were also living in the land.

[8] So Abram said to Lot, "Please let there be no contention between you and me, or between your herdsmen and my herdsmen. After all, we are brothers." [9] "Is not the whole land before you? Now separate yourself from me. If you go to the left, I will go to the right; if you go to the right, I will go to the left." [10] And Lot looked out and saw that the whole plain of the Jordan, all the way to Zoar, was well watered like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt. (This was before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah.) [11] So Lot chose the whole plain of the Jordan for himself and set out toward the east. And Abram and Lot parted company. [12] Abram lived in the land of Canaan, but Lot settled in the cities of the plain and pitched his tent toward Sodom. [13] But the men of Sodom were wicked, sinning greatly against the LORD. [14] After Lot had departed, the LORD said to Abram, "Now lift up your eyes from the place where you are, and look to the north and south and east and west," [15] for all the land that you see, I will give to you and your offspring forever. [16] I will make your offspring like the dust of the earth, so that if one could count the dust of the earth, then your offspring could be counted. [17] "Get up and walk around the land, through its length and breadth, for I will give it to you." [18] So Abram moved his tent and went to live near the Oaks of Mamre at Hebron, where he built an altar to the LORD.

14 In those days Amraphel king of Shinar, Arioch king of Ellasar, Chedorlaomer king of Elam, and Tidal king of Goiim [2] went to war against Bera king of Sodom, Birsha king of Gomorrah, Shinab king of Admah, Shemeber king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar). [3] The latter five came as allies to the Valley of Siddim (that is, the Salt Sea). [4] For twelve years they had been subject to Chedorlaomer, but in the thirteenth year they rebelled. [5] In the fourteenth year, Chedorlaomer and the kings allied with him went out and defeated the Rephaites in Ashteroth-karnaim, the Zuzites in Ham, the Emites in Shaveh-kiriathaim, [6] and the Horites in the area of Mount Seir, as far as El-paran, which is near the desert. [7] Then they turned back to invade En-mishpat (that is, Kadesh), and they conquered the whole territory of the Amalekites, as well as the Amorites who lived in Hazazon-tamar.

[8] Then the king of Sodom, the king of Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (that is, Zoar) marched out and arrayed themselves for battle in the Valley of Siddim [9] against Chedorlaomer king of Elam, Tidal king of Goiim, Amraphel king of Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar —four kings against five. [10] Now the Valley of Siddim was full of tar pits, and as the kings of Sodom and Gomorrah fled, some men fell into the pits, but the survivors fled to the hill country. [11] The four kings seized all the goods of Sodom and Gomorrah and all their food, and they went on their way. [12] They also carried off Abram's nephew Lot and his possessions, since Lot was living in Sodom. [13] Then an escapee came and reported this to Abram the Hebrew. Now Abram was living near the Oaks of Mamre the Amorite, a brother of Eshcol and Aner, all of whom were bound by treaty to Abram. [14] And when Abram heard that his relative had been captured, he mobilized the 318 trained men born in his household, and they set out in pursuit as far as Dan. [15] During the night, Abram divided his forces and routed Chedorlaomer's army, pursuing them as far as Hobah, north of Damascus.

[16] He retrieved all the goods, as well as his relative Lot and his possessions, together with the women and the rest of the people. [17] After Abram returned from defeating Chedorlaomer and the kings allied with him, the king of Sodom went out to meet him in the Valley of Shaveh (that is, the King's Valley).

[18] Then Melchizedek king of Salem brought out bread and wine—since he was priest of God Most High— [19] and he blessed Abram and said: "Blessed be Abram by God Most High, Creator of heaven and earth," [20] "and blessed be God Most High, who has delivered your enemies into your hand." Then Abram gave Melchizedek a tenth of everything. [21] The king of Sodom said to Abram, "Give me the people, but take the goods for yourself." [22] But Abram replied to the king of Sodom, "I have raised my hand to the LORD God Most High, Creator of heaven and earth," [23] that I will not accept even a thread, or a strap of a sandal, or anything that belongs to you, lest you should say, 'I have made Abram rich.' [24] "I will accept nothing but what my men have eaten and the share for the men who went with me—Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. They may take their portion."

15 After these events, the word of the LORD came to Abram in a vision: "Do not be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your very great reward." [2] But Abram replied, "O Lord GOD, what can You give me, since I remain childless, and the heir of my house is Eliezer of Damascus?" [3] Abram continued, "Behold, You have given me no offspring, so a servant in my household will be my heir." [4] Then the word of the LORD came to Abram, saying, "This one will not be your heir, but one who comes from your own body will be your heir." [5] And the LORD took him outside and said, "Now look to the heavens and count the stars, if you are able." Then He told him, "So shall your offspring be." [6] Abram believed the LORD, and it was credited to him as righteousness.

[7] The LORD also told him, "I am the LORD, who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldeans to give you this land to possess." [8] But Abram replied, "Lord GOD, how can I know that I will possess it?" [9] And the LORD said to him, "Bring Me a heifer, a goat, and a ram, each three years old, along with a turtledove and a young pigeon." [10] So Abram brought all these to Him, split each of them down the middle, and laid the halves opposite each other. The birds, however, he did not cut in half. [11] And the birds of prey descended on the carcasses, but Abram drove them away. [12] As the sun was setting, Abram fell into a deep sleep, and suddenly great terror and darkness overwhelmed him.

[13] Then the LORD said to Abram, "Know for certain that your descendants will be strangers in a land that is not their own, and they will be enslaved and mistreated four hundred years."

[14] But I will judge the nation they serve as slaves, and afterward they will depart with many possessions. [15] You, however, will go to your fathers in peace and be buried at a ripe old age. [16] "In the fourth generation your descendants will return here, for the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet complete." [17] When the sun had set and darkness had fallen, behold, a smoking firepot and a flaming torch appeared and passed between the halves of the carcasses. [18] On that day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying, "To your descendants I have given this land—from the river of Egypt to the great River Euphrates—" [19] the land of the Kenites, Kenizzites, Kadmonites, [20] Hittites, Perizzites, Rephaites, [21] "Amorites, Canaanites, Girgashites, and Jebusites."

16 Now Abram's wife Sarai had borne him no children, but she had an Egyptian maidservant named Hagar. [2] So Sarai said to Abram, "Look now, the LORD has prevented me from bearing children. Please go to my maidservant; perhaps I can build a family by her." And Abram listened to the voice of Sarai. [3] So after he had lived in Canaan for ten years, his wife Sarai took her Egyptian maidservant Hagar and gave her to Abram to be his wife. [4] And he slept with Hagar, and she conceived. But when Hagar realized that she was pregnant, she began to despise her mistress. [5] Then Sarai said to Abram, "May the wrong done

to me be upon you! I delivered my servant into your arms, and ever since she saw that she was pregnant, she has treated me with contempt. May the LORD judge between you and me." [6] "Here," said Abram, "your servant is in your hands. Do whatever you want with her." Then Sarai treated Hagar so harshly that she fled from her. [7] Now the angel of the LORD found Hagar by a spring of water in the desert—the spring along the road to Shur. [8] "Hagar, servant of Sarai," he said, "where have you come from, and where are you going?" "I am running away from my mistress Sarai," she replied. [9] So the angel of the LORD told her, "Return to your mistress and submit to her authority." [10] Then the angel added, "I will greatly multiply your offspring so that they will be too numerous to count." [11] The angel of the LORD proceeded: "Behold, you have conceived and will bear a son. And you shall name him Ishmael, for the LORD has heard your cry of affliction." [12] "He will be a wild donkey of a man, and his hand will be against everyone, and everyone's hand against him; he will live in hostility toward all his brothers."

[13] So Hagar gave this name to the LORD who had spoken to her: "You are the God who sees me," for she said, "Here I have seen the One who sees me!" [14] Therefore the well was called Beer-lahai-roi. It is located between Kadesh and Bered. [15] And Hagar bore Abram a son, and Abram gave the name Ishmael to the son she had borne. [16] Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to him.

17 When Abram was ninety-nine years old, the LORD appeared to him and said, "I am God Almighty. Walk before Me and be blameless." [2] "I will establish My covenant between Me and you, and I will multiply you exceedingly." [3] Then Abram fell facedown, and God said to him, [4] "As for Me, this is My covenant with you: You will be the father of many nations." [5] No longer will you be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham, for I have made you a father of many nations. [6] I will make you exceedingly fruitful; I will make nations of you, and kings will descend from you. [7] I will establish My covenant as an everlasting covenant between Me and you and your descendants after you, to be your God and the God of your descendants after you. [8] "And to you and your descendants I will give the land where you are residing—all the land of Canaan—as an eternal possession; and I will be their God."

[9] God also said to Abraham, "You must keep My covenant—you and your descendants in the generations after you." [10] This is My covenant with you and your descendants after you, which you are to keep: Every male among you must be circumcised. [11] You are to circumcise the flesh of your foreskin, and this will be a sign of the covenant between Me and you. [12] Generation after generation, every male must be circumcised when he is eight days old, including those born in your household and those purchased from a foreigner—even those who are not your offspring. [13] Whether they are born in your household or purchased, they must be circumcised. My covenant in your flesh will be an everlasting covenant. [14] "But if any male is not circumcised, he will be cut off from his people; he has broken My covenant." [15] Then God said to Abraham, "As for Sarai your wife, do not call her Sarai, for her name is to be Sarah." [16] "And I will bless her and will surely give you a son by her. I will bless her, and she will be the mother of nations; kings of peoples will descend from her."

[17] Abraham fell facedown. Then he laughed and said to himself, "Can a child be born to a man who is a hundred years old? Can Sarah give birth at the age of ninety?"

[18] And Abraham said to God, "O that Ishmael might live under Your blessing!" [19] But God replied, "Your wife Sarah will indeed bear you a son, and you are to name him Isaac. I will establish My covenant with him as an everlasting covenant for his descendants after him." [20] As for Ishmael, I have heard you, and I will surely bless him; I will make him fruitful and multiply him greatly. He will become the father of twelve rulers, and I will make him into a great nation. [21] "But I will establish My covenant with Isaac, whom Sarah will bear to you at this time next year." [22] When He had finished speaking with Abraham, God went up from him. [23] On that very day Abraham took his son Ishmael and all those born in his household or purchased with his money—every male among the members of Abraham's household—and he circumcised them, just as God had told him. [24] So Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised, [25] and his son Ishmael was thirteen; [26] Abraham and his son Ishmael were circumcised on the same day. [27] And all the men of Abraham's household—both servants born in his household and those purchased from foreigners—were circumcised with him.

18 Then the LORD appeared to Abraham by the Oaks of Mamre in the heat of the day, while he was sitting at the entrance of his tent. [2] And Abraham looked up and saw three men standing nearby. When he saw them, he ran from the entrance of his tent to meet them and bowed low to the ground. [3] "My lord," said Abraham, "if I have found favor in your sight, please do not pass your servant by." [4] Let a little water be brought, that you may wash your feet and rest yourselves under the tree. [5] "And I will bring a bit of bread so that you may refresh yourselves. This is why you have passed your servant's way. After that, you may continue on your way." "Yes," they replied, "you may do as you have said." [6] So Abraham hurried into the tent and said to Sarah, "Quick! Prepare three seahs of fine flour, knead it, and bake some bread." [7] Meanwhile, Abraham ran to the herd, selected a tender and choice calf, and gave it to a servant, who hurried to prepare it. [8] Then Abraham brought curds and milk and the calf that had been prepared, and he set them before the men and stood by them under the tree as they ate. [9] "Where is your wife Sarah?" they asked. "There, in the tent," he replied. [10] Then the LORD said, "I will surely return to you at this time next year, and your wife Sarah will have a son!" Now Sarah was behind him, listening at the entrance to the tent.

[11] And Abraham and Sarah were already old and well along in years; Sarah had passed the age of childbearing. [12] So she laughed to herself, saying, "After I am worn out and my master is old, will I now have this pleasure?" [13] And the LORD asked Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh and say, 'Can I really bear a child when I am old?'" [14] "Is anything too difficult for the LORD? At the appointed time I will return to you—in about a year—and Sarah will have a son."

[15] But Sarah was afraid, so she denied it and said, "I did not laugh." "No," replied the LORD, "but you did laugh." [16] When the men got up to leave, they looked out over Sodom, and Abraham walked along with them to see them off. [17] And the LORD said, "Shall I hide from Abraham what I am about to do?" [18] Abraham will surely become a great and powerful nation, and through him all the nations of the earth will be blessed. [19] "For I have chosen him, so that he will command his children and his household after him to keep the way of the LORD by doing what is right and just, in order that the LORD may bring upon Abraham what He has promised." [20] Then the LORD said, "The outcry against Sodom and Gomorrah is great. Because their sin is so grievous," [21] "I will go down to see if their actions fully justify the outcry that has reached Me. If not, I will find out."

[22] And the two men turned away and went toward Sodom, but Abraham remained standing before the LORD. [23] Abraham stepped forward and said, "Will You really sweep away the righteous with the wicked?" [24] What if there are fifty righteous ones in the city? Will You really sweep it away and not spare the place for the sake of the fifty righteous ones who are there? [25] "Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?" [26] So the LORD replied, "If I find fifty righteous ones within the city of Sodom, on their account I will spare the whole place." [27] Then Abraham answered, "Now that I have ventured to speak to the Lord—though I am but dust and ashes—" [28] "suppose the fifty righteous ones lack five. Will You destroy the whole city for the lack of five?" He replied, "If I find forty-five there, I will not destroy it." [29] Once again Abraham spoke to the LORD, "Suppose forty are found there?" He answered, "On account of the forty, I will not do it." [30] Then Abraham said, "May the Lord not be angry, but let me speak further. Suppose thirty are found there?" He replied, "If I find thirty there, I will not do it." [31] And Abraham said, "Now that I have ventured to speak to the Lord, suppose twenty are found there?" He answered, "On account of the twenty, I will not destroy it." [32] Finally, Abraham said, "May the Lord not be angry, but let me speak once more. Suppose ten are found there?" And He answered, "On account of the ten, I will not destroy it." [33] When the LORD had finished speaking with Abraham, He departed, and Abraham returned home.

19 Now the two angels arrived at Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting in the gateway of the city. When Lot saw them, he got up to meet them, bowed facedown, [2] and said, "My lords, please turn aside into the house of your servant; wash your feet and spend the night. Then you can rise early and go on your way." "No," they answered, "we will spend the night in the square." [3] But Lot insisted so strongly that they followed him into his house. He prepared a feast for them and baked unleavened bread, and they ate. [4] Before they had gone to bed, all the men of the city of Sodom, both young and old, surrounded the house. [5] They called out to Lot, saying, "Where are the men who came to you tonight? Send them out to us so we can have relations with them!" [6] Lot went outside to meet them, shutting the door behind him. [7] "Please, my brothers," he pleaded, "don't do such a wicked thing!" [8] "Look, I have two daughters who have never slept with a man. Let me bring them to you, and you can do to them as you please. But do not do anything to these men, for they have come under the protection of my roof." [9] "Get out of the way!" they replied. And they declared, "This one came here as a foreigner, and he is already acting like a judge! Now we will treat you worse than them." And they pressed in on Lot and moved in to break down the door. [10] But the men inside reached out, pulled Lot into the house with them, and shut the door. [11] And they struck the men at the entrance, young and old, with blindness, so that they wearied themselves trying to find the door.

[12] Then the two men said to Lot, "Do you have anyone else here—a son-in-law, your sons or daughters, or anyone else in the city who belongs to you? Get them out of here," [13] "because we are about to destroy this place. For the outcry to the LORD against its people is so great that He has sent us to destroy it." [14] So Lot went out and spoke to the sons-in-law who were pledged in marriage to his daughters. "Get up," he said. "Get out of this place, for the LORD is about to destroy the city!" But his sons-in-law thought he was joking. [15] At daybreak the angels hurried Lot along, saying, "Get up! Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, or you will be swept away in the punishment of the city." [16] But when Lot hesitated, the men grabbed his hand and the hands of his wife and his two daughters. And they led them safely out of the city, because of the LORD's compassion for them. [17] As soon as the men had brought them out, one of them said, "Run for your lives! Do not look back, and do not stop anywhere on the plain! Flee to the mountains, or you will be swept away!" [18] But Lot replied, "No, my lords, please!" [19] Your servant has indeed found favor in your sight, and you have shown me great kindness by sparing my life. But I cannot run to the mountains; the disaster will overtake me, and I will die.

20 "Look, there is a town nearby where I can flee, and it is a small place. Please let
me flee there—is it not a small place? Then my life will be saved." 21 "Very well,"
he answered, "I will grant this request as well, and will not demolish the town
you indicate." 22 "Hurry! Run there quickly, for I cannot do anything until you
reach it." That is why the town was called Zoar. 23 And by the time the sun had
risen over the land, Lot had reached Zoar. 24 Then the LORD rained down sulfur
and fire on Sodom and Gomorrah—from the LORD out of the heavens.

25 Thus He destroyed these cities and the entire plain, including all the
inhabitants of the cities and everything that grew on the ground. 26 But Lot's wife
looked back, and she became a pillar of salt. 27 Early the next morning, Abraham
got up and returned to the place where he had stood before the LORD. 28 He
looked down toward Sodom and Gomorrah and all the land of the plain, and he
saw the smoke rising from the land like smoke from a furnace. 29 So when God
destroyed the cities of the plain, He remembered Abraham, and He brought Lot
out of the catastrophe that destroyed the cities where he had lived. 30 Lot and his
two daughters left Zoar and settled in the mountains—for he was afraid to stay
in Zoar—where they lived in a cave. 31 One day the older daughter said to the
younger, "Our father is old, and there is no man in the land to sleep with us, as is
the custom over all the earth." 32 "Come, let us get our father drunk with wine so
we can sleep with him and preserve his line." 33 So that night they got their father
drunk with wine, and the firstborn went in and slept with her father; he was not
aware when she lay down or when she got up. 34 The next day the older daughter
said to the younger, "Look, I slept with my father last night. Let us get him drunk
with wine again tonight so you can go in and sleep with him and we can preserve
our father's line." 35 So again that night they got their father drunk with wine, and
the younger daughter went in and slept with him; he was not aware when she lay
down or when she got up. 36 Thus both of Lot's daughters became pregnant by
their father. 37 The older daughter gave birth to a son and named him Moab. He
is the father of the Moabites of today. 38 The younger daughter also gave birth to a
son, and she named him Ben-ammi. He is the father of the Ammonites of today.

20 Now Abraham journeyed from there to the region of the Negev and
settled between Kadesh and Shur. While he was staying in Gerar, 2 Abraham
said of his wife Sarah, "She is my sister." So Abimelech king of Gerar had Sarah
brought to him. 3 One night, however, God came to Abimelech in a dream and
told him, "You are as good as dead because of the woman you have taken, for she is
a married woman." 4 Now Abimelech had not gone near her, so he replied, "Lord,
would You destroy a nation even though it is innocent?" 5 "Didn't Abraham tell
me, 'She is my sister'? And she herself said, 'He is my brother.' I have done this
in the integrity of my heart and the innocence of my hands." 6 Then God said to
Abimelech in the dream, "Yes, I know that you did this with a clear conscience,
and so I have kept you from sinning against Me. That is why I did not let you
touch her." 7 "Now return the man's wife, for he is a prophet; he will pray for
you and you will live. But if you do not restore her, be aware that you will surely
die—you and all who belong to you."

8 Early the next morning Abimelech got up and summoned all his servants; and
when he described to them all that had happened, the men were terrified. 9 Then
Abimelech called Abraham and asked, "What have you done to us? How have I
sinned against you, that you have brought such tremendous guilt upon me and
my kingdom? You have done things to me that should not be done." 10 Abimelech
also asked Abraham, "What prompted you to do such a thing?" 11 Abraham
replied, "I thought to myself, 'Surely there is no fear of God in this place. They
will kill me on account of my wife.'" 12 Besides, she really is my sister, the daughter
of my father—though not the daughter of my mother—and she became my wife.
13 "So when God had me journey from my father's house, I said to Sarah, 'This
is how you can show your loyalty to me: Wherever we go, say of me, "He
is my brother."'" 14 So Abimelech brought sheep and cattle, menservants and
maidservants, and he gave them to Abraham and restored his wife Sarah to him.
15 And Abimelech said, "Look, my land is before you. Settle wherever you please."
16 And he said to Sarah, "See, I am giving your brother a thousand pieces of silver.
It is your vindication before all who are with you; you are completely cleared."
17 Then Abraham prayed to God, and God healed Abimelech and his wife and
his maidservants, so that they could again bear children— 18 for on account
of Abraham's wife Sarah, the LORD had completely closed all the wombs in
Abimelech's household.

21 Now the LORD attended to Sarah as He had said, and the LORD did for
Sarah what He had promised. 2 So Sarah conceived and bore a son to Abraham
in his old age, at the very time God had promised. 3 And Abraham gave the
name Isaac to the son Sarah bore to him. 4 When his son Isaac was eight days
old, Abraham circumcised him, as God had commanded him. 5 Abraham was a
hundred years old when his son Isaac was born to him. 6 Then Sarah said, "God
has made me laugh, and everyone who hears of this will laugh with me." 7 She
added, "Who would have told Abraham that Sarah would nurse children? Yet I
have borne him a son in his old age." 8 So the child grew and was weaned, and
Abraham held a great feast on the day Isaac was weaned. 9 But Sarah saw that
the son whom Hagar the Egyptian had borne to Abraham was mocking her son,
10 and she said to Abraham, "Expel the slave woman and her son, for the slave
woman's son will never share in the inheritance with my son Isaac!"

11 Now this matter distressed Abraham greatly because it concerned his
son Ishmael. 12 But God said to Abraham, "Do not be distressed about the boy
and your maidservant. Listen to everything that Sarah tells you, for through Isaac
your offspring will be reckoned." 13 "But I will also make a nation of the slave
woman's son, because he is your offspring."

14 Early in the morning, Abraham got up, took bread and a skin of water,
put them on Hagar's shoulders, and sent her away with the boy. She left and
wandered in the Wilderness of Beersheba. 15 When the water in the skin was
gone, she left the boy under one of the bushes. 16 Then she went off and sat down
nearby, about a bowshot away, for she said, "I cannot bear to watch the boy die!"
And as she sat nearby, she lifted up her voice and wept. 17 Then God heard the
voice of the boy, and the angel of God called to Hagar from heaven, "What is
wrong, Hagar? Do not be afraid, for God has heard the voice of the boy where
he lies." 18 "Get up, lift up the boy, and take him by the hand, for I will make him
into a great nation." 19 Then God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water.
So she went and filled the skin with water and gave the boy a drink. 20 And God
was with the boy, and he grew up and settled in the wilderness and became a
great archer. 21 And while he was dwelling in the Wilderness of Paran, his mother
got a wife for him from the land of Egypt.

22 At that time Abimelech and Phicol the commander of his army said to
Abraham, "God is with you in all that you do." 23 "Now, therefore, swear to
me here before God that you will not deal falsely with me or my children
or descendants. Show to me and to the country in which you reside the same
kindness that I have shown to you." 24 And Abraham replied, "I swear it." 25 But
when Abraham complained to Abimelech about a well that Abimelech's servants
had seized, 26 Abimelech replied, "I do not know who has done this. You did
not tell me, so I have not heard about it until today." 27 So Abraham brought
sheep and cattle and gave them to Abimelech, and the two men made a covenant.
28 Abraham separated seven ewe lambs from the flock, 29 and Abimelech asked
him, "Why have you set apart these seven ewe lambs?" 30 He replied, "You are to
accept the seven ewe lambs from my hand as my witness that I dug this well." 31 So
that place was called Beersheba, because it was there that the two of them swore
an oath. 32 After they had made the covenant at Beersheba, Abimelech and Phicol
the commander of his army got up and returned to the land of the Philistines.
33 And Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in Beersheba, and there he called upon
the name of the LORD, the Eternal God. 34 And Abraham resided in the land of
the Philistines for a long time.

22 Some time later God tested Abraham and said to him, "Abraham!" "Here
I am," he answered. 2 "Take your son," God said, "your only son Isaac, whom
you love, and go to the land of Moriah. Offer him there as a burnt offering on
one of the mountains, which I will show you." 3 So Abraham got up early the
next morning, saddled his donkey, and took along two of his servants and his
son Isaac. He split the wood for a burnt offering and set out for the place God
had designated. 4 On the third day Abraham looked up and saw the place in
the distance. 5 "Stay here with the donkey," Abraham told his servants. "The boy
and I will go over there to worship, and then we will return to you." 6 Abraham
took the wood for the burnt offering and placed it on his son Isaac. He himself
carried the fire and the sacrificial knife, and the two of them walked on together.
7 Then Isaac said to his father Abraham, "My father!" "Here I am, my son," he
replied. "The fire and the wood are here," said Isaac, "but where is the lamb for
the burnt offering?"

8 Abraham answered, "God Himself will provide the lamb for the burnt
offering, my son." And the two walked on together. 9 When they arrived at the
place God had designated, Abraham built the altar there and arranged the wood.
He bound his son Isaac and placed him on the altar, atop the wood. 10 Then
Abraham reached out his hand and took the knife to slaughter his son.

11 Just then the angel of the LORD called out to him from heaven, "Abraham,
Abraham!" "Here I am," he replied. 12 "Do not lay a hand on the boy or do
anything to him," said the angel, "for now I know that you fear God, since you
have not withheld your only son from me." 13 Then Abraham looked up and
saw behind him a ram in a thicket, caught by its horns. So he went and took
the ram and offered it as a burnt offering in place of his son. 14 And Abraham
called that place The LORD Will Provide. So to this day it is said, "On the
mountain of the LORD it will be provided." 15 And the angel of the LORD
called to Abraham from heaven a second time, 16 saying, "By Myself I have sworn,
declares the LORD, that because you have done this and have not withheld
your only son," 17 I will surely bless you, and I will multiply your descendants
like the stars in the sky and the sand on the seashore. Your descendants will
possess the gates of their enemies. 18 "And through your offspring all nations of
the earth will be blessed, because you have obeyed My voice." 19 Abraham went
back to his servants, and they got up and set out together for Beersheba. And
Abraham settled in Beersheba. 20 Some time later, Abraham was told, "Milcah
has also borne sons to your brother Nahor:" 21 Uz the firstborn, his brother Buz,
Kemuel (the father of Aram), 22 "Chesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, and Bethuel."
23 And Bethuel became the father of Rebekah. Milcah bore these eight sons to
Abraham's brother Nahor. 24 Moreover, Nahor's concubine, whose name was
Reumah, bore Tebah, Gaham, Tahash, and Maacah.

23 Now Sarah lived to be 127 years old. 2 She died in Kiriath-arba (that is,
Hebron) in the land of Canaan, and Abraham went out to mourn and to weep
for her. 3 Then Abraham got up from beside his dead wife and said to the Hittites,
4 "I am a foreigner and an outsider among you. Give me a burial site among you so

that I can bury my dead." [5] The Hittites replied to Abraham, [6] "Listen to us, sir. You are God's chosen one among us. Bury your dead in the finest of our tombs. None of us will withhold his tomb for burying your dead." [7] Then Abraham rose and bowed down before the people of the land, the Hittites. [8] "If you are willing for me to bury my dead," he said to them, "listen to me, and approach Ephron son of Zohar on my behalf" [9] "to sell me the cave of Machpelah that belongs to him; it is at the end of his field. Let him sell it to me in your presence for full price, so that I may have a burial site." [10] Now Ephron was sitting among the sons of Heth. So in the presence of all the Hittites who had come to the gate of his city, Ephron the Hittite answered Abraham, [11] "No, my lord. Listen to me. I give you the field, and I give you the cave that is in it. I give it to you in the presence of my people. Bury your dead." [12] Again Abraham bowed down before the people of the land [13] and said to Ephron in their presence, "If you will please listen to me, I will pay you the price of the field. Accept it from me, so that I may bury my dead there." [14] Ephron answered Abraham, [15] "Listen to me, my lord. The land is worth four hundred shekels of silver, but what is that between you and me? Bury your dead."

[16] Abraham agreed to Ephron's terms and weighed out for him the price he had named in the hearing of the Hittites: four hundred shekels of silver, according to the standard of the merchants. [17] So Ephron's field at Machpelah near Mamre, the cave that was in it, and all the trees within the boundaries of the field were deeded over [18] to Abraham's possession in the presence of all the Hittites who had come to the gate of his city. [19] After this, Abraham buried his wife Sarah in the cave of the field at Machpelah near Mamre (that is, Hebron) in the land of Canaan. [20] So the field and its cave were deeded by the Hittites to Abraham as a burial site.

24 By now Abraham was old and well along in years, and the LORD had blessed him in every way. [2] So Abraham instructed the chief servant of his household, who managed all he owned, "Place your hand under my thigh," [3] and I will have you swear by the LORD, the God of heaven and the God of earth, that you will not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites among whom I am dwelling, [4] "but will go to my country and my kindred to take a wife for my son Isaac." [5] The servant asked him, "What if the woman is unwilling to follow me to this land? Shall I then take your son back to the land from which you came?" [6] Abraham replied, "Make sure that you do not take my son back there." [7] The LORD, the God of heaven, who brought me from my father's house and my native land, who spoke to me and promised me on oath, saying, 'To your offspring I will give this land'—He will send His angel before you so that you can take a wife for my son from there. [8] "And if the woman is unwilling to follow you, then you are released from this oath of mine. Only do not take my son back there." [9] So the servant placed his hand under the thigh of his master Abraham and swore an oath to him concerning this matter. [10] Then the servant took ten of his master's camels and departed with all manner of good things from his master in hand. And he set out for Nahor's hometown in Aram-naharaim. [11] As evening approached, he made the camels kneel down near the well outside the town at the time when the women went out to draw water. [12] "O LORD, God of my master Abraham," he prayed, "please grant me success today, and show kindness to my master Abraham." [13] Here I am, standing beside the spring, and the daughters of the townspeople are coming out to draw water. [14] "Now may it happen that the girl to whom I say, 'Please let down your jar that I may drink,' and who responds, 'Drink, and I will water your camels as well'—let her be the one You have appointed for Your servant Isaac. By this I will know that You have shown kindness to my master." [15] Before the servant had finished praying, Rebekah came out with her jar on her shoulder. She was the daughter of Bethuel son of Milcah, the wife of Abraham's brother Nahor. [16] Now the girl was very beautiful, a virgin who had not had relations with any man. She went down to the spring, filled her jar, and came up again. [17] So the servant ran to meet her and said, "Please let me have a little water from your jar." [18] "Drink, my lord," she replied, and she quickly lowered her jar to her hands and gave him a drink. [19] After she had given him a drink, she said, "I will also draw water for your camels, until they have had enough to drink." [20] And she quickly emptied her jar into the trough and ran back to the well to draw water, until she had drawn water for all his camels. [21] Meanwhile, the man watched her silently to see whether or not the LORD had made his journey a success.

[22] And after the camels had finished drinking, he took out a gold ring weighing a beka, and two gold bracelets for her wrists weighing ten shekels. [23] "Whose daughter are you?" he asked. "Please tell me, is there room in your father's house for us to spend the night?" [24] She replied, "I am the daughter of Bethuel, the son that Milcah bore to Nahor." [25] Then she added, "We have plenty of straw and feed, as well as a place for you to spend the night." [26] Then the man bowed down and worshiped the LORD, [27] saying, "Blessed be the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who has not withheld His kindness and faithfulness from my master. As for me, the LORD has led me on the journey to the house of my master's relatives." [28] The girl ran and told her mother's household about these things. [29] Now Rebekah had a brother named Laban, and he rushed out to the man at the spring. [30] As soon as he saw the ring, and the bracelets on his sister's wrists, and heard Rebekah's words, "The man said this to me," he went and found the man standing by the camels near the spring. [31] "Come, you who are blessed by the LORD," said Laban. "Why are you standing out here? I have prepared the house and a place for the camels." [32] So the man came to the house, and the camels were unloaded. Straw and feed were brought to the camels, and water to wash his feet and the feet of his companions. [33] Then a meal was set before the man, but he said, "I will not eat until I have told you what I came to say." So Laban said, "Please speak." [34] "I am Abraham's servant," he replied. [35] "The LORD has greatly blessed my master, and he has become rich. He has given him sheep and cattle, silver and gold, menservants and maidservants, camels and donkeys." [36] My master's wife Sarah has borne him a son in her old age, and my master has given him everything he owns. [37] My master made me swear an oath and said, 'You shall not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites in whose land I dwell,' [38] but you shall go to my father's house and to my kindred to take a wife for my son.' [39] Then I asked my master, 'What if the woman will not come back with me?' [40] And he told me, 'The LORD, before whom I have walked, will send His angel with you and make your journey a success, so that you may take a wife for my son from my kindred and from my father's house.' [41] And when you go to my kindred, if they refuse to give her to you, then you will be released from my oath.' [42] So when I came to the spring today, I prayed: O LORD, God of my master Abraham, if only You would make my journey a success! [43] Here I am, standing beside this spring. Now if a maiden comes out to draw water and I say to her, 'Please let me drink a little water from your jar,' [44] and she replies, 'Drink, and I will draw water for your camels as well,' may she be the woman the LORD has appointed for my master's son. [45] And before I had finished praying in my heart, there was Rebekah coming out with her jar on her shoulder, and she went down to the spring and drew water. So I said to her, 'Please give me a drink.' [46] She quickly lowered her jar from her shoulder and said, 'Drink, and I will water your camels as well.' So I drank, and she also watered the camels. [47] Then I asked her, 'Whose daughter are you?' She replied, 'The daughter of Bethuel son of Nahor, whom Milcah bore to him.' So I put the ring on her nose and the bracelets on her wrists. [48] Then I bowed down and worshiped the LORD; and I blessed the LORD, the God of my master Abraham, who led me on the right road to take the granddaughter of my master's brother for his son. [49] "Now if you will show kindness and faithfulness to my master, tell me; but if not, let me know, so that I may go elsewhere." [50] Laban and Bethuel answered, "This is from the LORD; we have no choice in the matter." [51] "Rebekah is here before you. Take her and go, and let her become the wife of your master's son, just as the LORD has decreed." [52] When Abraham's servant heard their words, he bowed down to the ground before the LORD. [53] Then he brought out jewels of silver and gold, and articles of clothing, and he gave them to Rebekah. He also gave precious gifts to her brother and her mother. [54] Then he and the men with him ate and drank and spent the night there. When they got up the next morning, he said, "Send me on my way to my master." [55] But her brother and mother said, "Let the girl remain with us ten days or so. After that, she may go." [56] But he replied, "Do not delay me, since the LORD has made my journey a success. Send me on my way so that I may go to my master." [57] So they said, "We will call the girl and ask her opinion." [58] They called Rebekah and asked her, "Will you go with this man?" "I will go," she replied. [59] So they sent their sister Rebekah on her way, along with her nurse and Abraham's servant and his men. [60] And they blessed Rebekah and said to her, "Our sister, may you become the mother of thousands upon thousands. May your offspring possess the gates of their enemies." [61] Then Rebekah and her servant girls got ready, mounted the camels, and followed the man. So the servant took Rebekah and left. [62] Now Isaac had just returned from Beer-lahai-roi, for he was living in the Negev. [63] Early in the evening, Isaac went out to the field to meditate, and looking up, he saw the camels approaching. [64] And when Rebekah looked up and saw Isaac, she got down from her camel [65] and asked the servant, "Who is that man in the field coming to meet us?" "It is my master," the servant answered. So she took her veil and covered herself. [66] Then the servant told Isaac all that he had done. [67] And Isaac brought her into the tent of his mother Sarah and took Rebekah as his wife. And Isaac loved her and was comforted after his mother's death.

25 Now Abraham had taken another wife, named Keturah, [2] and she bore him Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. [3] Jokshan was the father of Sheba and Dedan. And the sons of Dedan were the Asshurites, the Letushites, and the Leummites. [4] The sons of Midian were Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were descendants of Keturah. [5] Abraham left everything he owned to Isaac. [6] But while he was still alive, Abraham gave gifts to the sons of his concubines and sent them away from his son Isaac to the land of the east. [7] Abraham lived a total of 175 years. [8] And at a ripe old age he breathed his last and died, old and contented, and was gathered to his people. [9] His sons Isaac and Ishmael buried him in the cave of Machpelah near Mamre, in the field of Ephron son of Zohar the Hittite. [10] This was the field that Abraham had bought from the Hittites. Abraham was buried there with his wife Sarah.

[11] After Abraham's death, God blessed his son Isaac, who lived near Beer-lahai-roi. [12] This is the account of Abraham's son Ishmael, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's maidservant, bore to Abraham. [13] These are the names of the sons of Ishmael in the order of their birth: Nebaioth the firstborn of Ishmael, then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam, [14] Mishma, Dumah, Massa, [15] Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah.

[16] These were the sons of Ishmael, and these were their names by their villages and encampments—twelve princes of their tribes. [17] Ishmael lived a total of 137 years. Then he breathed his last and died, and was gathered to his people. [18] Ishmael's descendants settled from Havilah to Shur, which is near the border of Egypt as you go toward Asshur. And they lived in hostility toward all their brothers. [19] This is the account of Abraham's son Isaac. Abraham became the father

of Isaac, [20] and Isaac was forty years old when he married Rebekah, the daughter of Bethuel the Aramean from Paddan-aram and the sister of Laban the Aramean. [21] Later, Isaac prayed to the LORD on behalf of his wife, because she was barren. And the LORD heard his prayer, and his wife Rebekah conceived.

[22] But the children inside her struggled with each other, and she said, "Why is this happening to me?" So Rebekah went to inquire of the LORD, [23] and He declared to her: "Two nations are in your womb, and two peoples from within you will be separated; one people will be stronger than the other, and the older will serve the younger." [24] When her time came to give birth, there were indeed twins in her womb. [25] The first one came out red, covered with hair like a fur coat; so they named him Esau. [26] After this, his brother came out grasping Esau's heel; so he was named Jacob. And Isaac was sixty years old when the twins were born. [27] When the boys grew up, Esau became a skillful hunter, a man of the field, while Jacob was a quiet man who stayed at home. [28] Because Isaac had a taste for wild game, he loved Esau; but Rebekah loved Jacob. [29] One day, while Jacob was cooking some stew, Esau came in from the field and was famished. [30] He said to Jacob, "Let me eat some of that red stew, for I am famished." (That is why he was also called Edom.) [31] "First sell me your birthright," Jacob replied. [32] "Look," said Esau, "I am about to die, so what good is a birthright to me?" [33] "Swear to me first," Jacob said. So Esau swore to Jacob and sold him the birthright. [34] Then Jacob gave some bread and lentil stew to Esau, who ate and drank and then got up and went away. Thus Esau despised his birthright.

26 Now there was another famine in the land, subsequent to the one that had occurred in Abraham's time. And Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Philistines at Gerar. [2] The LORD appeared to Isaac and said, "Do not go down to Egypt. Settle in the land where I tell you." [3] Stay in this land as a foreigner, and I will be with you and bless you. For I will give all these lands to you and your offspring, and I will confirm the oath that I swore to your father Abraham. [4] I will make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky, and I will give them all these lands, and through your offspring all nations of the earth will be blessed, [5] "because Abraham listened to My voice and kept My charge, My commandments, My statutes, and My laws." [6] So Isaac settled in Gerar. [7] But when the men of that place asked about his wife, he said, "She is my sister." For he was afraid to say, "She is my wife," since he thought to himself, "The men of this place will kill me on account of Rebekah, because she is so beautiful." [8] When Isaac had been there a long time, Abimelech king of the Philistines looked down from the window and was surprised to see Isaac caressing his wife Rebekah. [9] Abimelech sent for Isaac and said, "So she is really your wife! How could you say, 'She is my sister'?" Isaac replied, "Because I thought I might die on account of her." [10] "What is this you have done to us?" asked Abimelech. "One of the people could easily have slept with your wife, and you would have brought guilt upon us."

[11] So Abimelech warned all the people, saying, "Whoever harms this man or his wife will surely be put to death." [12] Now Isaac sowed seed in the land, and that very year he reaped a hundredfold. And the LORD blessed him, [13] and he became richer and richer, until he was exceedingly wealthy. [14] He owned so many flocks and herds and servants that the Philistines envied him. [15] So the Philistines took dirt and stopped up all the wells that his father's servants had dug in the days of his father Abraham.

[16] Then Abimelech said to Isaac, "Depart from us, for you are much too powerful for us." [17] So Isaac left that place and encamped in the Valley of Gerar and settled there. [18] Isaac reopened the wells that had been dug in the days of his father Abraham, which the Philistines had stopped up after Abraham died. And he gave these wells the same names his father had given them. [19] Then Isaac's servants dug in the valley and found a well of fresh water there. [20] But the herdsmen of Gerar quarreled with Isaac's herdsmen and said, "The water is ours!" So he named the well Esek, because they contended with him. [21] Then they dug another well and quarreled over that one also; so he named it Sitnah. [22] He moved on from there and dug another well, and they did not quarrel over it. He named it Rehoboth and said, "At last the LORD has made room for us, and we will be fruitful in the land."

[23] From there Isaac went up to Beersheba, [24] and that night the LORD appeared to him and said, "I am the God of your father Abraham. Do not be afraid, for I am with you. I will bless you and multiply your descendants for the sake of My servant Abraham." [25] So Isaac built an altar there and called on the name of the LORD, and he pitched his tent there. His servants also dug a well there. [26] Later, Abimelech came to Isaac from Gerar, with Ahuzzath his adviser and Phicol the commander of his army. [27] "Why have you come to me?" Isaac asked them. "You hated me and sent me away." [28] "We can plainly see that the LORD has been with you," they replied. "We recommend that there should now be an oath between us and you. Let us make a covenant with you" [29] "that you will not harm us, just as we have not harmed you but have done only good to you, sending you on your way in peace. And now you are blessed by the LORD." [30] So Isaac prepared a feast for them, and they ate and drank. [31] And they got up early the next morning and swore an oath to each other. Then Isaac sent them on their way, and they left him in peace. [32] On that same day, Isaac's servants came and told him about the well they had dug. "We have found water!" they told him. [33] So he called it Shibah, and to this day the name of the city is Beersheba. [34] When Esau was forty years old, he took as his wives Judith daughter of Beeri the Hittite and Basemath daughter of Elon the Hittite. [35] And they brought grief to Isaac and Rebekah.

27 When Isaac was old and his eyes were so weak that he could no longer see, he called his older son Esau and said to him, "My son." "Here I am," Esau replied. [2] "Look," said Isaac, "I am now old, and I do not know the day of my death." [3] Take your weapons—your quiver and bow—and go out into the field to hunt some game for me. [4] "Then prepare a tasty dish that I love and bring it to me to eat, so that I may bless you before I die." [5] Now Rebekah was listening to what Isaac told his son Esau. So when Esau went into the field to hunt game and bring it back, [6] Rebekah said to her son Jacob, "Behold, I overheard your father saying to your brother Esau," [7] 'Bring me some game and prepare me a tasty dish to eat, so that I may bless you in the presence of the LORD before I die.' [8] Now, my son, listen to my voice and do exactly as I tell you. [9] Go out to the flock and bring me two choice young goats, so that I can make them into a tasty dish for your father —the kind he loves. [10] "Then take it to your father to eat, so that he may bless you before he dies." [11] Jacob answered his mother Rebekah, "Look, my brother Esau is a hairy man, but I am smooth-skinned." [12] "What if my father touches me? Then I would be revealed to him as a deceiver, and I would bring upon myself a curse rather than a blessing." [13] His mother replied, "Your curse be on me, my son. Just obey my voice and go get them for me." [14] So Jacob went and got two goats and brought them to his mother, who made the tasty food his father loved.

[15] And Rebekah took the finest clothes in the house that belonged to her older son Esau, and she put them on her younger son Jacob. [16] She also put the skins of the young goats on his hands and on the smooth part of his neck. [17] Then she handed her son Jacob the tasty food and bread she had made. [18] So Jacob went to his father and said, "My father." "Here I am!" he answered. "Which one are you, my son?" [19] Jacob said to his father, "I am Esau, your firstborn. I have done as you told me. Please sit up and eat some of my game, so that you may bless me."

[20] But Isaac asked his son, "How did you ever find it so quickly, my son?" "Because the LORD your God brought it to me," he replied. [21] Then Isaac said to Jacob, "Please come closer so I can touch you, my son. Are you really my son Esau, or not?" [22] So Jacob came close to his father Isaac, who touched him and said, "The voice is the voice of Jacob, but the hands are the hands of Esau." [23] Isaac did not recognize him, because his hands were hairy like those of his brother Esau; so he blessed him. [24] Again he asked, "Are you really my son Esau?" And he replied, "I am." [25] "Serve me," said Isaac, "and let me eat some of my son's game, so that I may bless you." Jacob brought it to him, and he ate; then he brought him wine, and he drank. [26] Then his father Isaac said to him, "Please come near and kiss me, my son." [27] So he came near and kissed him. When Isaac smelled his clothing, he blessed him and said: "Ah, the smell of my son is like the smell of a field that the LORD has blessed." [28] May God give to you the dew of heaven and the richness of the earth— an abundance of grain and new wine. [29] "May peoples serve you and nations bow down to you. May you be the master of your brothers, and may the sons of your mother bow down to you. May those who curse you be cursed, and those who bless you be blessed."

[30] As soon as Isaac had finished blessing him and Jacob had left his father's presence, his brother Esau returned from the hunt. [31] He too made some tasty food, brought it to his father, and said to him, "My father, sit up and eat of your son's game, so that you may bless me." [32] But his father Isaac replied, "Who are you?" "I am Esau, your firstborn son," he answered. [33] Isaac began to tremble violently and said, "Who was it, then, who hunted the game and brought it to me? Before you came in, I ate it all and blessed him—and indeed, he will be blessed!" [34] When Esau heard his father's words, he let out a loud and bitter cry and said to his father, "Bless me too, O my father!" [35] But Isaac replied, "Your brother came deceitfully and took your blessing." [36] So Esau declared, "Is he not rightly named Jacob? For he has cheated me twice. He took my birthright, and now he has taken my blessing." Then he asked, "Haven't you saved a blessing for me?" [37] But Isaac answered Esau: "Look, I have made him your master and given him all his relatives as servants; I have sustained him with grain and new wine. What is left that I can do for you, my son?" [38] Esau said to his father, "Do you have only one blessing, my father? Bless me too, O my father!" Then Esau wept aloud.